



A Real Audit — Studio Name Removed

This is an actual inquiry-path audit we ran on a real dance studio's website, delivered exactly as the studio received it. We've removed the studio's name and identifying details — nothing else has been changed. It is not a testimonial, endorsement, or client case study.

A note on the fix tags below

Every fix below is tagged by who can do it. Some are things you can do yourself or hand to whoever helps with your site; some are changes to your existing site that you may want a web person's help with; and a few may need outside help to build — meaning a new piece that doesn't exist on your site yet, not just an edit to what's there. Which tag a fix gets depends on how a studio's website is set up. On a drag-and-drop platform (Wix, Squarespace, and similar), most copy and text fixes are genuinely do-it-yourself. On a custom-built site, many of those same fixes go through whoever built it — not because they're harder, but because there's no visual editor to change them in. Every real audit we deliver is tiered to the studio's actual setup, which we ask about up front. The tags shown here reflect a typical do-it-yourself platform.

What this audit looks for

A dance studio website does not just need to look nice. It needs to help a busy parent move from “I'm interested” to “I know what to do next.”

This review looks at the public parent path:

Homepage → getting started page → programs/classes → inquiry form or registration portal → parent decides whether to take the next step.

Overall diagnosis

The studio had a credible public presence, useful program information, visible contact options, and a registration portal. The main roadblock was not that the website was bad. The roadblock was that the parent had to make too many decisions too early.

In other words: the website was giving dance studio information, but not enough parent decision support.

A new parent is not usually asking, “Can I technically create an account somewhere?” They are asking:

- Which class is right for my child?
- Is my child too young, too old, or too inexperienced?
- Can we try before committing?
- What does it cost?
- What should my child wear?
- Will someone help me choose, or do I have to decode the schedule myself?

When those answers are scattered across the site, even an interested parent can pause. And “I'll come back later” is where good inquiries quietly disappear.

Roadblock 1: The registration portal appears too early

What I saw:



The public path gave parents a “register now” option that led into the studio management / registration portal. That is helpful for existing families and ready-to-enroll parents, but it can be too abrupt for brand-new families.

Why it's a roadblock:

A new parent may click “register” before they know which class to choose. When they land in an account/login/portal experience, they may wonder:

- Am I registering for a class, a trial, or just an account?
- Am I committing to something?
- Which class am I supposed to pick?
- Should I talk to someone first?

That moment of uncertainty is small, but small uncertainty is often enough to delay action. Then life eats the follow-up.

Recommended fix:

[This one may need outside help to build — it's a new piece that doesn't exist on your site yet, not just an edit to what's there]

The registration platform's account-creation flow is a fixed part of the platform and can't simply be switched off. What's fixable is the sequencing: give curious parents a softer, no-account-required step first (a “tell us about your dancer” form or a phone call) before ever pointing them at registration. Make the primary new-family call to action (CTA) “Find the Right Class” or “Request a Free Trial,” and use “Register Now” as a secondary option for parents who already know what they want. That soft step is the new piece that would need to be built.

Roadblock 2: The inquiry form collects interest, but does not fully guide the parent

What I saw:

The public inquiry path invited parents to request more information, a trial, or a tour. That is a strong start. But the surrounding copy did not clearly tell the parent what happens after they submit.

Why it's a roadblock:

A parent filling out a form wants reassurance. They want to know someone will help them choose, not just receive their message. Missing reassurance often sounds like:

- How soon will someone respond?
- Will they recommend a class?
- Do I need to know the right level first?
- Is the trial actually free?
- Should I register before hearing back?

Recommended fix:

[You can do this yourself, or hand it to whoever helps with your site]

Add a clear promise above the form: “Not sure which class is right? Tell us your dancer's age, experience, and interests, and we'll recommend the best fit. Most families hear back within 1 business day.” Then change the button from “SEND MESSAGE” to “Help Me Find a Class” or “Request My Trial Class.”

Roadblock 3: Program information is useful, but the decision path is scattered



What I saw:

The studio had multiple program categories, schedules, tuition details, and registration options. That is useful information, but a new parent still had to interpret the structure alone.

Why it's a roadblock:

Dance people understand program levels. New parents often do not. They may not know whether their child belongs in a beginner class, performance track, pre-professional track, trial class, summer program, or something else entirely.

This is a common pattern worth naming on its own: studios often use internal program names that make complete sense to staff and current families, but carry no meaning for someone brand new. The fix here is never to rename these — those names likely carry real internal meaning, and changing them risks confusing existing families to solve a problem for new ones, trading one roadblock for another.

Recommended fix:

[You can do this yourself, or hand it to whoever helps with your site]

Add one short, plain-language sentence under each program name, written for someone who has never set foot in a dance studio — keeping the name exactly as-is. Frame it around the parent's experience (“a new parent can't tell what these classes are for”), not as a critique of the naming. You know the real distinctions between your tiers; just add a plain sentence describing each. A simple “Start Here” guide by age and experience helps too, ending with: “Not sure? Request a free trial and we'll place your dancer.”

Roadblock 4: The site has too many calls to action competing at once

What I saw:

The public path included several possible actions: getting started, registering, viewing programs, buying tickets, learning more, contacting the studio, using the parent portal, and browsing schedules. None of those are wrong. The issue is priority.

Why it's a roadblock:

A homepage often has to serve new families, current families, ticket buyers, summer camp families, serious-track dancers, and general browsers. But if every action looks equally important, new parents may not know which door is for them.

Recommended fix:

[This one's a change to your existing site — you may want a web person's help]

Reworking the homepage hierarchy so one new-family path leads is structural, but doable with basic web skills. Use one clear new-family path above the fold: “New to the studio? We'll help you find the right class,” with buttons for “Find My Dancer's Class” and “Request a Free Trial.” Then, below that, clearly separate paths for existing families, ticket buyers, and everyone else.

Roadblock 5: The inquiry form is not asking the most useful questions

What I saw:

The current form captured basic interest but left out the details that let the studio respond with an actual recommendation — things like the dancer's experience, preferred contact method, and what the family is actually looking for.

Why it's a roadblock:



Without those details, the studio may receive leads like “Interested in hip hop. Age 9–12. Message: info please.” Staff then has to manually chase follow-up questions. Every extra back-and-forth is a place the inquiry can slow down or disappear.

Recommended fix:

[You can do this yourself, or hand it to whoever helps with your site] if your form builder allows adding fields — otherwise you may want a web person's help, especially if the form is embedded from another tool

Use a dedicated class-recommendation form with fields for: parent/guardian name, email, phone, preferred contact method (text, email, or phone), dancer's name, dancer's age, dance experience, what they're interested in (free trial, weekly classes, summer camp, advanced/competitive program, or not sure yet), styles of interest, best days/times, and a message. The most important addition is preferred contact method: if a parent responds fastest by text, email-only follow-up may lose them.

Roadblock 6: Small trust and consistency issues add quiet friction

What I saw:

Across the public pages there were small inconsistencies: a navigation link pointing to a different contact email than the one shown elsewhere, two different zip codes between the contact page and footer, a stray error message in a page footer, a couple of typos in class/camp listings, and a few likely AM/PM time errors in schedules.

Why it's a roadblock:

None of these are catastrophic on their own. But each tiny inconsistency makes a parent think “Is this up to date?” Tiny doubt adds up to a lost inquiry.

Recommended fix:

[You can do this yourself, or hand it to whoever helps with your site]

Use one official email everywhere, fix the zip-code inconsistency, remove the error message from the footer, and correct the typos and time errors in public listings. These are all copy/text corrections in your site editor and platform settings.

Biggest hidden opportunity

The money is probably not in making the website prettier. The money is in:

- faster inquiry response
- clearer class placement guidance
- easier trial scheduling
- better follow-up after no response
- better follow-up after a trial
- less parent confusion before registration

The studio should not rely on a parent being motivated enough to decode schedules, portals, class levels, tuition, and policies by themselves. The better message is simple: “Tell us a little about your dancer. We'll guide you.” That is the missing bridge between “interested parent” and “enrolled student.”

One more note before rolling any of this out: if more than one person answers phones or emails at the studio, take a few minutes to walk your team through whatever changes you make. It keeps everyone giving parents the same answer.



How this applies to the full Inquiry Roadblock Audit

A full audit reviews the public parent path from first interest — inquiry/trial — enrollment and identifies the places families may be pausing, getting confused, or choosing the exit. This sample shows the kind of practical review a studio receives: not vague marketing advice, not “just post more on Instagram,” and not a 40-page PDF that immediately goes to live in a folder called Later. Just the roadblocks, the reason they matter, and the fixes.

Prepared by Inquiry Rescue

inquiryrescue.com

